

CHANDIGARH | Reality Check

YASBANT NEGI



CHAND AND FIZA
MAKE THE NEWS

Fiza a.k.a. Anuradha Bali is one woman who knows how to stay on the front pages and occupy prime time television space. The former assistant advocate general of Haryana has been more in the news in recent times for the tumultuous marriage and divorce—all in less than two months—with former Haryana deputy chief minister Chander Mohan, son of veteran Congressman Bhajan Lal. Fiza converted to Islam and tried to commit suicide as the marriage went sour after Chander a.k.a. Chand Mohammed sent her a text message

from London that read 'Talaq, Talaq, Talaq'. She's sworn to follow him to the end of the world, but for the moment is enjoying the minor celebrityhood that comes with reality tv. "It is good that people consider me an all-rounder," she says.

by Arvind Chhabra

LUCKNOW | Cover-UP

Nobody knows the rules of governance better than Mayawati, quite literally. After realising that people are using the Right to Information (RTI) Act to dig deep into her government's financial and other activities, she made attempts to dilute the Act and suppress information. She first took 14 subjects away from the Act's purview but later relented to keep five subjects out. This right to dilute the powerful Act is unusual but in Maya's land, as the ad says, impossible is nothing.

by Farzand Ahmed

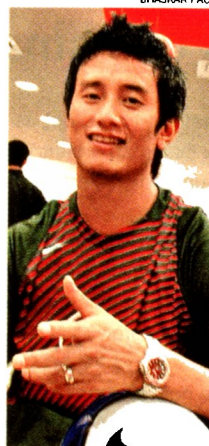
KOLKATA | Red-carded

**CLUB
SECRETARY
ANJAN MITRA
SAYS MOHUN
BAGAN FAILED
TO WIN THE
I-LEAGUE DUE
TO BAICHUNG
BHUTIA'S POOR
PERFORMANCE.**

Sometimes you can be a winner and still lose. Ask India football captain Baichung Bhutia. Mohun Bagan have suspended the star player for six months. The reason is that the club says he took a lot more time than he had taken permission from the club for taking part in the tv dance show *Jhalak Dikhlai Jaa 3*, which he eventually won. The twinkle-toed Bhutia was showcaused for not turning up for training sessions and then missing a club exhibition match. Both former and current players have, however, rallied around India's ace striker.

by Elora Sen

BHASKAR PAUL



LANGUAGE SPELLS TROUBLE FOR STUDENTS OF ENGLISH-MEDIUM SCHOOLS IN KARNATAKA

BANGALORE | Medium Malaise

The language controversy in the state never seems to end. The war between private unaided schools that want to use English as the medium of instruction and an unflinching state government that wants it to be Kannada has left parents of children attending English-medium schools in the lurch.

The court battle has dragged on. The state Government did not heed an April 6, 2009, Karnataka High Court directive to register English-medium schools within four weeks. The reason? One cited was a 1994 mandatory formula to teach in Kannada. The state then appealed to the Supreme Court which agreed to hear the plea but didn't grant a stay on the high court order. A section of the schools has also moved the Karnataka High Court on June 1, 2009, to serve a contempt notice on officials of the Education Department.

by Stephen David



ENGLISH OR KANNADA? CHILDREN
SUFFER AS THE BATTLE DRAGS ON

SARVA SHIKSHA ABHIYAN